To be sure, my first reaction had been of miserable envy—Bob could make the Post and I couldn't even make Thrilling Wonder. It didn't take much thought, however, for me to see that Bob had done us all a terrific favor and that there was reason to rejoice. Every science-fiction writer would find the world easier for him because Heinlein had made the field more respectable and, sooner or later, we would all profit as a result. Between Heinlein and the atom bomb, it became difficult to think of science fiction as childish and silly anymore, and there were great days ahead.

Heinlein no longer wrote for Astounding, however. I think he and Campbell must have come to a bitter parting of the ways over something. I don't know what it was. Campbell never volunteered information, and I didn't think it proper to ask.

I got a letter from Lieutenant Kriegman on December 2, except that he was Captain Kriegman now. He wanted Gertrude and me to visit him at his home in Newark. I was tempted, but the date of the visit coincided with my initiation into Phi Lambda Upsilon, the chemists' honor society.

I had the choice between looking back toward the horrible days of the Army or forward toward a possibly glowing chemical career, and I

chose to look forward. It was a hard choice and it rather spoiled the initiation for me since Kriegman had been good to me. For some years after that, I got a card from Kriegman each Christmas with a letter written across it. I responded each time, urging him to write more often, but he never did.

By and large, in this second period of research at Columbia, I dealt with a new generation. The fellow students of 1939 to 1942 were all gone, and the fellow students of 1946 were unknown to me. There were occasional connections, though.

I met Ira Weill, for instance, who, except for red hair, looked very much like Lester Weill of Hilltop days. They were brothers and from Ira I learned that Lester was married and was at the University of Akron.

I made new friends, of course. One graduate student was a beautiful red-headed girl named Gerry, brilliant and full of drive. I admired her enormously, and not just for her beauty. We used to argue the matter of feminism in those days. She complained bitterly about the difficulties women encountered in entering scientific research.

I was sympathetic but, playing devil's advocate, I pointed out that there was